Comparative Government

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Final Essay

FINAL ESSAY
THE IMPACT OF THE PRINTING PRESS
ON MEDIEVAL EUROPE.

Submission details & format

- **Deadline**: April 9, 2026, by 12pm (midday/noon)
- **Word Count**: 1,500 words maximum (includes in-text references)
- **Style**: Formal case study (no personal commentary)
- **Referencing**:
  - Use a professional style (Harvard/APSA)
  - In-text citations must include page numbers
  - Full bibliography required

Core requirements

- **Event Selection**: One or two locations based on events from the last 12 months
- **Theoretical Application**: Address **one** specific prompt using module readings and lectures
- **Sourcing**:
  - Use news sources (e.g., *Financial Times*) and thinktank reports for factual basis.
  - Prioritize Moodle materials and academic journals.
  - Engage thoroughly with course textbooks and lectures.

Questions

- **[Minorities]** Why are some states more tolerant of minorities than others?
- **[Constitutions]** Why do some constitutions protect rights better than others?
- **[Authoritarianism and Democratic Backsliding]** Why do some states move toward authoritarianism while others do not?
- **[Legislatures]** What is the role of legislatures in defending democracy?
- **[Elections]** Why do some elections attract higher voter turnout than others?

Exercise

- Identify your event(s)
- Explain how the chosen event(s) speak to one of the questions
- Specify relevant weeks for your essay